

ROBERT GERVAIS

CURRICULUM VITAE

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SKILLS

LANGUAGES

C/C++ (Proficient)
C# (Proficient)
Markdown (Expert)
Lua (Proficient)
Python (Basic)

GAME ENGINES

Unreal Engine (Expert)
UE for Fortnite (Expert)
Fortnite Creative (Expert)
Unity (Basic)
LÖVE (Proficient)

TECHNOLOGIES

Perforce/git (Proficient)
JIRA (Proficient)
OpenGL (Proficient)
DirectX (Proficient)
Confluence (Proficient)

TECHNICAL WRITING

Dialogue (Expert)
Documentation (Expert)
Collaboration (Expert)
Systems Design (Proficient)
Docs As Code (Expert)

EXPERIENCE

Owner & CTO — Chuckanut Systems, LLC (Satoyama Dice)

3/2025 – Present

- Architecting and implementing all of the game systems in Lua for a Sudoku puzzle game in LÖVE.
- Implementing all narrative elements to have a City Pop theme; writing shaders in GLSL for a retro look.
- Providing computer software design and game design services to private and public clients.

Programmer — Reverting Castles (Demon Crush)

3/2025 – Present

- Designing and implementing narrative systems in C++ for a single player action game in Unreal Engine 5.
- Implementing all levels in Tiled to integrate narrative design elements in the game's environment.
- Leading writing team to script Ukiyo-e cutscenes that tell a wordless story for a global audience.
- Implementing Blueprint Materials with Custom HLSL code that gives the game a retro arcade look.

Lead Writer & Creator — Seeds of Change

2019 – 2025

- Wrote and published a 280-page post-apocalyptic graphic novel, utilizing Scrivener and KindleCreator tooling.
- Structured non-linear narrative using the 5 Act Structure, Kishotenketsu, and Jo Ha Kyu frameworks.
- Integrated the novel's lore with the *Satoyama Dice* game via a custom Narrative Swatch System.

Education & Learning Director — Epic Games

2023 – 03/2025

- Led product documentation teams to unify all company documentation under a single landing page experience.
- Collaborated with engineering and UX teams to build the Epic Developer Assistant (AI-chatbot) for Unreal Engine.
- Managed documentation partnerships for major brands including Disney, LEGO, and Paramount.

Game Director — Epic Games (Talisman)

2023 – 2024

- Directed a cross-discipline team to ship a high-fidelity UEFN tech demo showcasing MetaHumans and realistic environments.
- Engineered optimization pipelines to scale AAA visuals from Nintendo Switch to high-end PCs.
- Delivered a full developer ecosystem, releasing a playable demo, two editable templates, documentation, and videos.
- Shipped Verse code snippets and dynamic cloth samples in Unreal Engine 5 to upskill the community.

Education & Learning Lead — Epic Games (Fortnite)

2021 – 2023

- Architected the Direct Event Binding solution, eliminating channel system complexity for Fortnite creators.
- Achieved 100% documentation coverage for the launch of Fortnite Creative, UEFN, and the Verse language.
- Utilized TLA+ to validate algorithms written in Verse, ensuring stability for concurrency constructs.
- Partnered with SEO/UX teams to achieve >90% CTR on top documentation pages via organic search.

Senior Technical Writer — Epic Games

2019 – 2021

- Interviewed 100+ engineers to develop a Simple Knowledge Organization System (SKOS) schema in Neo4j.
- Redesigned documentation Information Architecture for the UE5 launch using ANOVA analysis of card sort results.

Technical Writer — Epic Games

2017 – 2019

- Documented workflows for UnrealGameSync and distributed development tools (Perforce, binary builds).
- Authored Epic's first custom style guide, standardizing voice and tone across the company's technical content.

Lore Editor — Epic Games (Paragon)

2016 – 2018

- Edited game story content generated for the world-building initiative, ensuring narrative consistency.
- Collaborated with the Narrative Director to align written stories with the MOBA's characters and world.

Training Content Developer — Epic Games

2015 – 2017

- Developed a Visual Studio Extension to templatize Diataxis-based documentation for engineering teams.
- Created an Unreal Engine plugin allowing engineers to wrap functional gameplay code into APIDocTool snippets.

Technical Writing Intern — Epic Games

Summer 2015

- Debugged API calls (Linux, Android, and iOS) for the APIDocTool reflection system.
- Migrated legacy Unreal Tournament components to create the standard First Person Shooter sample for UE4.

Technical Director & Modeler — Team Code Fish (Breach)

2015 – 2016

- Managed workload of six programmers using JIRA and Trello; provided code reviews and maintained the repository.
- Wrote Core Engine code, registering hooks for the messaging service; solved complex physics and rendering problems.
- Modeled all of the game's props using Maya.

Lead Writer — DigiPen Minion News Reader

2012 – 2016

- Wrote and published narrative nonfiction articles, reviewing game consoles, video games, and board games.

Narrative Lead & Programmer — Team Synaptic Sugar (Relic)

2014 – 2015

- Formed and led a Writer's Room for a team of three; authored a Space Opera narrative with over 2,000 lines of dialogue.
- Created a 10,000-year history Story Bible, star maps, and a constructed alien language based on modern philology.
- Implemented Narrative System and UI for subtitles in C++; served as Lore Master to align art, audio, and design teams.
- Directed voice actors and wrote lyrics for the orchestral score; voted 1st place for Best Dialogue/Characters.

Game Writer & Engine Programmer — Team Enso (From Where She Dreams)

2013 – 2014

- Wrote Game Design Document and all dialogue; directed voice actors and recorded assets in the studio.
- Scripted Python prototypes for dialogue events; implemented final narrative logic using Lua.
- Developed core engine code including FMOD integration, GLUT hooks, and UI systems with haptic feedback.

Game Designer — Team Rock-it (Rock-it-Rails)

2013 – 2014

- Designed and prototyped the game's core rail mechanic, and designed all of the levels with a custom editor.

Technical Director & Associate Producer — 7th Circle Studios (Luminae)

2012 – 2013

- Managed workload of two programmers via JIRA; conducted code reviews and maintained rendering system.
- Solved animation/UI technical issues and wrote custom shaders for artists to implement in-game.

Engine Programmer, Level Designer & Artist — Team 0xDEADBEEF (0xCCELERATOR)

2011 – 2012

- Developed core engine source code, input systems, and integrated FMOD for the game's audio.
- Built a custom importer to utilize AutoCAD as the primary level design and character modeling tool.
- Designed the main character and modeled 2D assets in AutoCAD, integrating them via OBJ export.

Engine Programmer & Game Designer — Team Diatonic (Opus)

2010 – 2011

- Integrated Discrete Fast Fourier Transform to generate levels procedurally based on the beats of player MP3s.
- Designed the core game mechanic and implemented the Audio Zone Design framework.
- Implemented particle, physics, and input systems; optimized engine performance for major web browsers.

Lead Writer — DC Comics (Pirate Eye)

2009 – 2010

- Wrote the script, and published a one-shot comic bought by DC Comics for the Zuda Imprint.
- Led a team of two artists and one writer to port the comic to a tablet display format on iPad and Kindle.

GAME INDUSTRY WHITEPAPER

Epic Games Technical Whitepaper (2020): Workflow on Fortnite: Collaboration on large teams with UnrealGameSync

- Co-authored the industry-standard whitepaper on scaling AAA development, detailing the transition of *Fortnite's* pipeline from a legacy "build-to-fix" cycle to a decentralized workflow using UnrealGameSync (UGS).
- Documented the engineering architecture behind *Fortnite*, *Paragon*, and *Battle Breakers*, explaining how distributed teams use client-side filtering and automated bisecting to maintain stability while shipping daily updates to 350M+ players.

TRADITIONAL GAME DESIGN

Field of Glory (2014): Designed a hex open field game for medieval warfare. Inspired by *Warhammer 40K*.

Heroes of Fortune (2013): Designed a racetrack board game for dungeon crawl adventures. Inspired by *Zelda*.

Heist! (2012): Designed a competitive, multiplayer card game with dynamic rules. Inspired by *Fluxx*.

Joust (2011): Designed a fast paced, feudal dice game. Inspired by *Ludus latrunculorum*.

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Computer Science in Real-time Interactive Simulation

Graduated 12/2016

DigiPen Institute of Technology